

Nearly 1,400 Workers Lose Jobs at an Ohio Truck Factory

From: PBS NewsHour Mined: 2026-10-03 3 min read

Nearly 1,400 people lost their jobs on Wednesday, September 30, at a truck factory in Springfield, Ohio. The plant had been known as the Navistar factory.

A **layoff** means an employer ends a worker's job. For families, losing a steady **paycheck** can make everyday costs harder to manage. One affected worker, Kyle Bos, has two daughters and another child due in January. He described concerns about rising grocery prices as well as losing his job.

The **layoffs** were large enough to roughly cancel out an entire year of job growth in the greater Dayton area. They happened three days before President Donald Trump's Saturday **rally** nearby.

Dayton has a long history of making and inventing things. The Wright brothers' airplane and the electric car starter were among **inventions** developed there. But the region has lost about half of the 90,000 factory jobs it had in 1990, according to federal figures.

Other kinds of work have grown. Wright-Patterson Air Force Base now directly employs 38,000 people. Its work has helped attract **aerospace** companies, which develop aircraft and related technology.

The White House pointed to company **investments** as evidence that its policies are creating jobs. Jeff Hoagland, who leads the Dayton Development Coalition, said building an economy takes time. The factory **layoffs** show the difficulties some families still face.

Word Treasure

layoff -- When an employer ends a worker's job.

paycheck -- Money a worker receives for doing a job.

rally -- A gathering where people hear a political speaker.

inventions -- New things that people create.

aerospace -- Related to aircraft and technology for flight or space.

investments -- Money put into a business or project to help it grow.

Background you need

A layoff ends a worker's job and can affect the family's income.
Aerospace companies develop aircraft and related technology.

Break it down

The opening reports the Springfield truck factory layoffs and their date.
The next section explains layoffs and describes Kyle Bos's family concerns.
The article connects the job losses to regional growth and a nearby presidential rally.
It describes Dayton's invention history, declining factory jobs and aerospace employment.
It ends with the White House's position and Hoagland's explanation.

Why it matters

Jobs provide income for families. The layoffs help readers understand how families can face difficulties even while other businesses in their region grow.

Test what you remember

1. Where did nearly 1,400 people lose their jobs?
 - (A) At a Dayton electric car company
 - (B) At a Dayton grocery store
 - (C) At a Springfield truck factory
 - (D) At a Springfield aircraft company
2. What everyday expense concerned Kyle Bos?
 - (A) The rising cost of groceries
 - (B) The rising cost of bus tickets
 - (C) The rising cost of phone service
 - (D) The rising cost of school supplies
3. How did the layoffs compare with the area's job growth?
 - (A) They roughly canceled one year's growth
 - (B) They roughly canceled ten years' growth
 - (C) They roughly canceled one month's growth
 - (D) They roughly canceled five years' growth
4. Which invention does the article connect to Dayton?
 - (A) The electric car starter
 - (B) The portable music player
 - (C) The digital video camera
 - (D) The household washing machine
5. What happened to the region's factory jobs after 1990?
 - (A) About half were added
 - (B) Their number stayed unchanged
 - (C) Their number roughly doubled
 - (D) About half were lost
6. What did Jeff Hoagland say about building an economy?
 - (A) It takes one day
 - (B) It takes time
 - (C) It requires only factories
 - (D) It requires only aircraft

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: A 4: A 5: D 6: B

Questions to think about

1. **Kyle Bos:** He described concerns about rising grocery prices and losing his job.
2. **The White House:** It pointed to company investments as evidence that its policies are creating jobs.
3. **Jeff Hoagland:** He said building an economy takes time.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):